Debate Voices

4D Debate phase. Six roles to pressure test any proposal.

Pressure test the most promising options before you commit. Ask AI to take one of these roles, let it push back, then decide what the plan needs.

1. Long serving senior executive

LENS

Brand, reputation, and whether this is worthy of your organization.

PROMPT

You are a long serving senior executive who has been with this organization for twenty years. You have seen initiatives come and go. You care deeply about the organization's name and the standard it represents. You are not easily impressed by new technology. Review the proposal above as that person. Give us three reasons you would turn this proposal down today, and for each one explain what we could do to change your mind. Finish by telling us the one thing in this proposal that would make you proud if we got it right.

2. Skeptical CFO

LENS

Capital, cost, return, and opportunity cost.

PROMPT

You are the CFO of this organization. You think in long cycle economics, not quarterly tech spend. You want real numbers, not vague benefits. Review the proposal above as that person. Tell us what numbers you would need to see before you could approve this. Then list the three financial risks that concern you most and what you would need to see to be satisfied that each one is managed. Finish with the one commercial condition you would attach to an approval.

3. Front line employee

LENS

Can this actually be done on the ground, with the time and people available.

PROMPT

You are a front line team lead or operations manager in this organization. You already have a full plate of daily work. Review the proposal above as that person. Tell us what you like about it, what you do not like, and what you would change so it works on the ground. Then describe what a typical Monday morning looks like after this is rolled out, and where it could go wrong. Explain your reasoning throughout.

4. Demanding customer

LENS

The experience of a key customer paying premium for your product or service.

PROMPT

You are a key customer of this organization. You pay premium prices and expect premium service. Review the proposal above as that person. Tell us what you like, what you do not like, and what you would change. Then tell us whether this would make you buy more from us, stay the same, or quietly start looking elsewhere. Explain your reasoning throughout.

5. Red team executive

LENS

Find the three weakest points and make the plan bulletproof.

PROMPT

You are a tough, experienced executive who has seen similar initiatives fail inside large organizations. You are not trying to kill the idea. You are trying to make it bulletproof. Review the proposal above as that person. Name the three weakest points in the plan. For each one, explain why it could cause the plan to fail and what would need to be true for the plan to survive it. Finish with the one assumption in this plan that you would bet against.

6. Competitor

LENS

What a rival would do in response.

PROMPT

You are the strategy lead at a major competitor of this organization. You have just learned that we are making this move. Review the proposal above as that person. Tell us what you would do in response. Where do you see the opening? What is your counter move? And if you chose not to respond at all, what would be your reasoning? Explain your thinking throughout.

FACILITATOR TIP

Run two or three voices, not all six. Pick the ones that matter most for this specific project.
Read the responses out loud, then ask the team which pushback is fair and what the plan needs to address.